

My Favorite Books On Personal Development

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 12, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/QqcajG1d9wg> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs a head-to-head elimination bracket of popular personal development books, with *Meditations* dominating most matchups before losing to his all-time favorite: *How to Win Friends and Influence People*.

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🥊 Round 1: Early Matchups 0:00

- Brandon presents a series of head-to-head book comparisons, picking a winner each time
 - *The Way of the Superior Man* vs. *The Art of Seduction* → **The Way of the Superior Man**
 - *The Way of the Superior Man* vs. *No More Mr. Nice Guy* → *The Way of the Superior Man*
 - *The Way of the Superior Man* vs. *The 48 Laws of Power* → **The 48 Laws of Power**
 - *The 48 Laws of Power* vs. *The Rational Male* → *The 48 Laws of Power*
 - *The 48 Laws of Power* vs. *The Laws of Human Nature* → *The 48 Laws of Power*
 - *The 48 Laws of Power* vs. *Models* → *The 48 Laws of Power*
 - *The 48 Laws of Power* vs. *The 50th Law* → **The 50th Law**

📖 Round 2: Meditations Takes Over 0:22

- *The 50th Law* faces *Meditations* (by Marcus Aurelius) → **Meditations** wins and goes on a dominant run
 - *Meditations* vs. *Letters from a Stoic* → *Meditations*
 - *Meditations* vs. *Man's Search for Meaning* → *Meditations*
 - *Meditations* vs. *The Obstacle Is the Way* → *Meditations*
 - *Meditations* vs. *The Subtle Art of Not Giving Up* → *Meditations*
 - *Meditations* vs. *The Courage to Be Disliked* → *Meditations*
 - *Meditations* vs. *The Alchemist* → *Meditations*

🏆 The All-Time Favorite & Why 0:43

- *Meditations* is finally knocked out by *How to Win Friends and Influence People* by Dale Carnegie
- Brandon is asked point-blank: "Is that your favorite book of all time?"
 - His answer: "That's my favorite book of all time."
- His reasoning:
 - Mastering the principles in the book helps in **business**
 - Helps in all personal relationships
 - Helps with dating
 - His core argument: "Everything you need to do in life is going to involve people. And that book will help you deal with people better."

"There's nothing it won't help you with because everything you need to do in life is going to involve people."

- The segment closes with a question to the viewer/guest: "Have you actually read all those books?" — implying Brandon has read the full list himself